ASSIGNMENT NO.1

INSTRUCTOR: LÊ HOÀNG ANH

CLASS: MKT1903

COURSE: EXE101

GROUP: 3

NUMBER	NAME	ID STUDENT
1	NGUYỄN THỊ HẢI YẾN	HS170194
2	BÙI THỊ THÙY DƯƠNG	HS180238
3	TĂNG LAN ANH	HS180573
4	PHẠM THẾ SƠN	HE181997
5	NGUYỄN BÁ SƠN	HE186062
6	NGUYỄN PHÚC LÂM	HE196133

Table of content

1. ORGANIZATION OF COMPANY 4
2. PROJECT EVALUATION CRITERIA 7
2.1 INTRODUCTION 7
2.2. INNOVATION – PROJECT INNOVATION 7
2.3. FEASIBILITY – ANALYSIS OF FEASIBILITY 8
2.3.1. Market Feasibility 8
2.3.2. Technical Feasibility 8
2.3.3. Operational Feasibility 8
2.4. BIG IMPACT – POTENTIAL IMPACT OF THE PROJECT 8
2.5. MARKET SIZE – MARKET OPPORTUNITY 9
TAM – Total Addressable Market 9
SAM – Serviceable Available Market 9
SOM – Serviceable Obtainable Market (MVP Stage) 10
2.6. SCALE-UP ABILITY – SCALABILITY OF THE PROJECT 10
2.7. CONCLUSION 10
3. LEVELS OF PRODUCT/SERVICE 11
3.1. Core Product – Core Value 11
3.2. Actual Product – Tangible Offering 11
3.3. Augmented Product – Value-Added Services 12
4. MARKET ANALYSIS(POTENTIAL, SIZE, TRENDS) 13
4.1. Market Potential 13
4.2. Market Size 13
4. 3. Market Trends 13
5. KEYS PLAYERS 14
5.1. List of Leading Business Groups 14
5.2. Market Share of Key Competitors 14
5.3. Competitive Capabilities and Limitations of Key Players 15
5.4. Market Gap Analysis – Opportunities for the Project 15
5.5. Competitive Intensity 16
6. POSITIONING 17
6. 1. Analysis of Competitors' Positioning Criteria 17
6.2. Positioning Gap – Opportunity for the Project 17
6.3. Brand Positioning Strategy (Project) 17
7. COMPETITORS ANALYSIS 18
7.1. Objectives of the Analysis 18
7.2 Overview of Key Competitor Groups 18

7.3 Detailed Competitor Analysis **18**
7.3.1. Traditional Uniform Suppliers **18**
7.3.2. Nature of the Business Model **19**
7.3. Custom Merchandising Services **20**
7.4. Structural Limitations **21**
7.5. Overall Assessment **21**
8. SWOT **22**
8.1. Overview **22**
8.2. Strengths **22**
8.3. Weaknesses **22**
8.4. Opportunities **23**
8.5. Threats **23**
9. REFERENCES **23**

1. ORGANIZATION OF COMPANY

STT	Member	Position	Roles
1	Nguyễn Thị Hải Yến	CEO	• Strategic Commander-in-Chief: Defines the company's vision and long-term objectives. • Resource Allocation: Approves budgets and senior-level hiring decisions. • Company Representative: Acts as the company's spokesperson to partners, investors, and the media. • Corporate Culture Direction: Builds and shapes the company's working culture, product direction, and brand identity. • The CEO communicates the vision and strategic goals to the CMO, CPO, CDO, and CTO. • Works closely with the CMO to ensure marketing activities align with the overall business strategy. • Serves as the final decision gatekeeper for major product, design, and technology decisions.
2	Phạm Thế Sơn	CPO	• Owns the product lifecycle: From ideation → development → launch → continuous improvement. • Defines the product roadmap: Determines features, priorities, and development timelines. • User collaboration: Collects user feedback and continuously optimizes the user experience. • Works closely with the CDO to ensure the product design is visually appealing, user-friendly, and aligned with market expectations. • Collaborates with the CMO on product positioning, communication, and go-to-market activities.

			• Partners with the CTO to translate product vision into scalable and feasible technical solutions.
3	Tăng Lan Anh	CMO	• Develops and executes marketing strategies: Branding, Digital Marketing, and Public Relations. • Customer and market understanding: Conducts research on customer behavior, competitors, and market trends. • Brand and communications management: Takes ownership of brand identity, positioning, and messaging. • Sales enablement: Generates leads, increases brand awareness, and drives revenue through marketing campaigns.
4	Bùi Thị Thùy Dương	CFO	• Manages company-wide financial operations: Budgeting, cost control, cash flow management, and financial reporting. • Financial planning and resource allocation: Determines spending across marketing, R&D, design, and technology. • Ensures long-term financial sustainability: Oversees risk management, financial forecasting, and cost efficiency. • Supports strategic decision-making for the CEO: Provides financial insights on project feasibility and investment priorities.
5	Nguyễn Phúc Lâm	CTO	• Owns technology leadership: Infrastructure, product development, and system architecture. • Bridges technology and business: Ensures products are stable, scalable, and aligned with business objectives.

			• Drives technological innovation: Researches and adopts new technologies to maintain product competitiveness. • Receives requirements from the CPO and translates them into technical solutions. • Supports the CDO by ensuring UX/UI designs are technically feasible across platforms. • Provides analytics and performance data to the CMO to evaluate and optimize marketing effectiveness. • Advises the CEO on technological capabilities and constraints to help realize the company's long-term vision.
6	Nguyễn Bá Sơn	CDO	• Designs user experience and visual identity: UX/UI, product design, and branding. • Owns aesthetics and brand identity: Ensures visual quality and brand consistency across all touchpoints. • Ensures usability and visual coherence: Makes sure products are intuitive, visually appealing, and consistent in design. • Receives the product vision from the CPO and translates it into UI/UX design, packaging, and visual assets. • Supports the CMO in marketing campaigns by delivering creative concepts, visual designs, and branded content. • Collaborates with the CTO to ensure designs are technically feasible and properly implemented across digital products.

2. PROJECT EVALUATION CRITERIA

2.1 INTRODUCTION

In recent years, the consumption behavior of Vietnamese university students has undergone noticeable changes, particularly in fashion and lifestyle preferences. Although students generally maintain a strong sense of pride and emotional attachment to their universities, this sentiment is not reflected in their daily use of school-branded products such as uniforms or official merchandise. Most university apparel in Vietnam remains standardized, limited in design, and perceived as compulsory rather than desirable.

THE ALMA is a startup project developed to address this gap. The project proposes an **open uniform ecosystem**, allowing students to personalize school-branded products within a controlled institutional identity framework. The core objective of THE ALMA is to transform school-related apparel from mandatory items into products that students voluntarily choose to wear, thereby strengthening emotional connection, identity, and everyday relevance.

2.2. INNOVATION – PROJECT INNOVATION

THE ALMA's innovation lies not in advanced or complex technology, but in its **design philosophy and consumption model**.

Vietnam's fashion market has been experiencing steady growth. According to Statista, the apparel market in Vietnam is projected to reach approximately **USD 2.9 billion in 2025** and continue growing toward **USD 4 billion by 2030**, driven largely by young consumers and e-commerce adoption (Statista, Vietnam Fashion Market Outlook).

At the same time, reports from YouNet Media and YMER Digital highlight that **Gen Z consumers in Vietnam place strong value on self-expression, personalization, and emotional meaning in fashion**, particularly through online and social commerce platforms.

Despite these trends, university uniforms and school merchandise have remained largely unchanged, offering limited choice and minimal personalization.

THE ALMA introduces innovation through three key elements.
First, **controlled personalization**. Instead of unrestricted customization, the project defines a design framework for each university, including mandatory elements (logo, primary colors, core symbols) and flexible elements (layout, secondary colors, slogans, or personal names). This approach aligns with the concept of mass customization, allowing individuality without compromising institutional identity.

Second, **user co-creation**. Students are no longer passive buyers but active participants in the design process. This increases emotional attachment and perceived value of school-branded products.

Third, **ecosystem-based product strategy**. Rather than focusing on a single uniform item, THE ALMA develops a range of products such as T-shirts, hoodies, caps, socks, and accessories, reflecting modern student lifestyles.

Through these approaches, THE ALMA redefines how school identity and personal expression can coexist in contemporary Vietnamese university culture.

2.3. FEASIBILITY – ANALYSIS OF FEASIBILITY

2.3.1. Market Feasibility

Vietnam currently has approximately **2.1–2.3 million university and college students**, forming a large and recurring consumer base. In parallel, the **print-on-demand (POD) and customized apparel market in Vietnam is valued at around USD 1.1 billion**, reflecting strong consumer acceptance of made-to-order products (Ken Research, Vietnam Print on Demand Market).

This indicates that Vietnamese consumers—especially younger generations—are already familiar with personalization and are willing to pay for customized apparel, supporting the feasibility of THE ALMA's business model.

2.3.2. Technical Feasibility

THE ALMA does not depend on high-cost or advanced technologies. In its initial stage, the project can be implemented using:

- A basic web-based drag-and-drop customization interface
- Predefined design templates
- Semi-manual design approval workflows

This lean approach minimizes development risk while enabling rapid market validation, making it suitable for a student-led startup.

2.3.3. Operational Feasibility

Operationally, THE ALMA adopts a **pre-order and small-batch production model**, which reduces inventory risk, lowers upfront capital requirements, and allows quality control through selected local printing partners. Vietnam's well-developed garment manufacturing and printing ecosystem further strengthens operational feasibility.

Overall, THE ALMA demonstrates strong feasibility across market, technical, and operational dimensions.

2.4. BIG IMPACT – POTENTIAL IMPACT OF THE PROJECT

THE ALMA addresses a social and cultural problem rather than a purely functional one.

Vietnamese Gen Z consumers—estimated to represent **around 20% of the national population by 2025**—are key drivers of modern consumption trends, especially in fashion and lifestyle products (YMER Digital, Gen Z Consumer Insight Report).

For students, THE ALMA strengthens the sense of belonging and pride in their university by enabling them to express identity through products they genuinely like and choose to use. This helps bridge the gap between institutional identity and individual expression.

For universities, the project offers a modernized branding approach that maintains consistency while increasing engagement and visibility among students.

From a broader socio-cultural perspective, THE ALMA contributes to harmonizing modern youth expression with traditional academic identity in Vietnam. Economically, the project supports local garment and printing businesses and promotes demand-driven, small-batch production, indirectly reducing overproduction and waste.

2.5. MARKET SIZE – MARKET OPPORTUNITY

Vietnam's fashion market continues to expand rapidly, with growth driven by local brands, e-commerce, and personalization trends. Within this market, university students represent a **large, recurring, and concentrated niche segment**.

TAM – Total Addressable Market

TAM represents total annual fashion spending by all university students in Vietnam.

- Estimated number of students: **~2.3 million**
- Conservative average annual fashion spending per student: **~2,000,000 VND**

TAM ≈ 2.3 million × 2,000,000 VND
= 4,600 billion VND per year (~USD 180 million)

SAM – Serviceable Available Market

SAM represents spending specifically on school-related or customizable apparel.

- Estimated portion of students purchasing school-related products: **25%**
- Average annual spending on such products: **~500,000 VND**

SAM ≈ 2.3 million × 25% × 500,000 VND
= 287.5 billion VND per year (~USD 11.8 million)

SOM – Serviceable Obtainable Market (MVP Stage)

SOM reflects realistic market capture during the pilot phase.

- Pilot universities: 2–3
- Total students reached: ~30,000
- Estimated purchase rate: 10%
- Average order value: ~450,000 VND

SOM ≈ 30,000 × 10% × 450,000 VND
= ~135 million VND per year

These figures demonstrate that the market opportunity is sufficiently large while the initial revenue expectations remain realistic and achievable.

2.6. SCALE-UP ABILITY – SCALABILITY OF THE PROJECT

THE ALMA is designed for gradual and sustainable scaling.

Geographically, the model can expand from pilot universities to nationwide adoption, with each new institution following the same standardized design framework. Product-wise, the ecosystem can be extended to seasonal collections, event-based merchandise, alumni products, and limited editions.

From a systems perspective, manual processes used in early stages can be progressively automated, including design approval and order management. This allows THE ALMA to scale without proportional increases in operational costs.

As a result, the project demonstrates strong scalability potential in terms of users, locations, and product offerings.

2.7. CONCLUSION

THE ALMA is a hybrid startup project combining consumer products with supportive technology. Grounded in Vietnamese market trends and Gen Z consumer behavior, the project demonstrates clear innovation through controlled personalization, strong feasibility across multiple dimensions, positive social and cultural impact, and a scalable business model.

With a large and recurring student market and realistic MVP implementation, THE ALMA is well-positioned for further validation through surveys and pilot programs in selected universities.

3. LEVELS OF PRODUCT/SERVICE

3.1. Core Product – Core Value

THE ALMA does not merely sell T-shirts, hoodies, or school-branded merchandise. The core value delivered to students lies in the intangible benefits they receive, including:

- Sense of Belonging:

Students feel that they are an integral part of their school, class, or cohort through apparel that embodies shared identity and collective symbols.

- Institutional Pride:

Wearing school merchandise becomes an act of pride and self-identification rather than a compulsory obligation imposed by institutional rules.

- Personal Expression within a Collective Framework:

Students are able to personalize their apparel (e.g., names, graduation year, slogans, layouts) while still complying with the school's cultural norms and brand image.

At its core, THE ALMA resolves the tension between individual self-expression and the discipline and uniformity inherent in educational institutions. By doing so, it transforms school merchandise from a mandatory uniform into a lifestyle choice enriched with emotional and symbolic value.

3.2. Actual Product – Tangible Offering

At the level of the actual product, THE ALMA competes directly with traditional school merchandise and class-shirt providers through a set of tangible attributes:

- Product Assortment: T-shirts, hoodies, caps, socks, and accessories featuring school identity elements.
- Design and Silhouette: Modern, Gen Z–oriented styles such as oversized T-shirts and boxy hoodies that help eliminate the "uniform stigma" often associated with school apparel.

- Controlled Personalization: Instead of rigid and repetitive logos, THE ALMA offers a curated design asset system (redesigned mascots, stylized typography, and layout templates), enabling students to co-create designs within approved brand and cultural guidelines.
- Product Quality: The brand elevates standards from “promotional grade” to “retail fashion grade” by utilizing:
    - High-weight cotton fabrics
    - Structured silhouettes
    - High-resolution, durable digital printing
- Co-creation Platform: A web-based drag-and-drop design tool allows students with no formal design background to easily create personalized products.

This level represents the tangible layer of the product—what customers can physically see, touch, wear, and directly compare with competing offerings in the market.

3.3. Augmented Product – Value-Added Services

The most distinctive and sustainable competitive advantage of THE ALMA lies in its augmented product layer, which includes:

- Co-creation Experience: Students are not merely buyers but active participants in the product creation process, fostering a strong sense of ownership and emotional attachment.
- Lean Operations Model: A pre-order–based production system that:
    - Minimizes inventory risk
    - Reduces material waste
    - Aligns with the limited budgets of student classes and clubs
- Brand Safety Service: A fast and structured design approval process ensures that student-created designs comply with school regulations, cultural values, and institutional image standards.
- Community Engagement: Design contests and voting mechanisms allow students to select upcoming collections by school or faculty, strengthening community involvement and brand participation.
- Emotional and Memory Value: Products are tied to key milestones such as orientation, class events, graduation, and alumni activities, transforming school apparel into meaningful memorabilia.

These augmented elements are difficult for traditional print-on-demand or school-shirt shops to replicate, thereby establishing a long-term and defensible competitive advantage for THE ALMA.

4. MARKET ANALYSIS(POTENTIAL, SIZE, TRENDS)

4.1. Market Potential

The personalized fashion and custom apparel market shows strong potential as consumers increasingly seek products that reflect both collective identity and individual personality. In Vietnam, this trend is particularly prominent among young consumers, especially students, who are moving away from rigid, standardized uniforms toward more flexible and customizable apparel options.

Customizable school-identity apparel that integrates institutional elements such as logos and traditional colors with personal customization options, including names, color schemes, and graphic illustrations, represents a promising and still under-exploited market segment. This concept supports the development of an “open uniform ecosystem,” in which school identity is preserved while allowing users to express personal preferences and creativity.

The potential of this model is further strengthened by the growing popularity of personalized handcrafted products such as custom-printed T-shirts, hoodies, and accessories. These products satisfy two important consumer needs: the desire for individuality and the desire to belong to a specific community such as a class, department, club, or school. In addition, the widespread adoption of e-commerce and print-on-demand platforms enables easy ordering without mass production requirements, making personalized apparel accessible and scalable in the Vietnamese market.

4.2. Market Size

The market size for personalized fashion and custom apparel is supported by both domestic and global growth in the print-on-demand (POD) industry. In Vietnam, the POD market is estimated to be worth approximately USD 1.1 billion in 2024–2025, driven by the expansion of e-commerce, increasing consumer demand for customization, and advancements in digital printing technologies that allow high-quality single-item production.

Beyond POD platforms, Vietnam’s broader custom garment printing and personalized product manufacturing market is projected to reach approximately USD 1.15 billion, reflecting strong production capacity and industry readiness to support customization-based business models. Apparel products such as T-shirts and hoodies account for a significant share of this market due to high demand from young consumers and active social groups.

At the global level, the print-on-demand and personalized fashion market demonstrates substantial scale and long-term growth. The global POD market reached approximately USD 10.17 billion in 2024 and is expected to expand rapidly to around USD 67.59 billion by 2032, with a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of about 26.7%. This global market expansion reinforces the attractiveness and scalability of personalized apparel initiatives in Vietnam.

4. 3. Market Trends

One of the most prominent market trends shaping the industry is the rapid development of personalization and print-on-demand models. Modern consumers increasingly reject standardized, mass-produced fashion in favor of products that better reflect their personal style. As a result, POD and personalized fashion have become among the fastest-growing segments in Vietnam's online retail market.

At the same time, Vietnamese youth—particularly students and Gen Z—are emerging as the core consumer group driving this trend. This generation actively uses clothing and accessories as tools for self-expression and is highly engaged with digital platforms that enable customization. Their familiarity with web-based design tools and online ordering systems creates favorable conditions for platforms offering interactive apparel design experiences.

From a competitive perspective, while Vietnam already has several POD and custom-printing service providers, most focus on generic personalization (such as custom slogans or images) rather than structured solutions tailored to school identity and student communities. This creates a strategic opportunity for differentiated positioning: a platform that combines institutional branding with user-driven customization, targeting students, clubs, and school organizations as a distinct niche market.

Overall, current market trends, consumer behavior, and industry infrastructure collectively support the strong potential of a customizable school-identity apparel model in Vietnam.

5. KEYS PLAYERS

5.1. List of Leading Business Groups

The market is currently dominated by three main groups of players:

- **Traditional Enterprises (B2B):** Long-established manufacturers holding direct contracts with school boards. Typical examples include **May Phương Thảo** (dominating the Northern market with over 15 showrooms), **Hải Anh Uniform** (operating three large-scale factories), and **Bốn Mùa Uniform**.
- **E-commerce Retailers:** Domestic brands rapidly expanding on platforms such as Shopee and TikTok, including **Kookoo, Amazing, and Ardilla**. These players mainly focus on basic items with highly competitive pricing.
- **Local Brands & Merchandise (B2C):** Brands emphasizing student experience, such as **The High School Merchandise (THSM)**, **Jadiny** (premium segment), and in-house gift shops of international universities (e.g., **RMIT, VinUni, Fulbright**).

5.2. Market Share of Key Competitors

The **Traditional Enterprise group** holds the largest market share, accounting for approximately **75% of the total market**. This group consists mainly of conventional garment manufacturers and direct contractors. Key players such as May Phương Thảo and Hải Anh Uniform possess overwhelming advantages through long-term supply contracts with school administrations. Their revenue primarily comes from on-campus sales channels and long-established offline showroom networks.

The **fastest-growing segment** (approximately **15% market share**) belongs to **E-commerce retailers**. According to **Metric data (2025)**, Shopee currently dominates with over **58% of total online industry revenue**. This group attracts a large number of parents and students thanks to convenience and low prices, especially during peak back-to-school seasons.

Finally, **Local Brands and Merchandise projects** account for around **10% of the market**. Although their market share remains modest, this group demonstrates the strongest brand diffusion within **Gen Z student communities**. Rather than focusing on mass volume, these players target high-end niches in private and international universities (e.g., VinUni, Fulbright, RMIT, BUV), where students have a strong desire to express personal identity through school-related apparel.

5.3. Competitive Capabilities and Limitations of Key Players

A deeper analysis of competitive capabilities reveals significant differences among competitor groups, thereby creating substantial “white spaces” for the project.

For **traditional industry leaders**, their core competitive advantage lies in **economies of scale** and extensive distribution networks. However, their inherent weakness stems from **rigid, outdated design thinking**, with fabric choices prioritizing durability over comfort. As a result, their products remain merely “mandatory attire” rather than evolving into **functional fashion items**.

In contrast, **E-commerce retailers** compete primarily on **speed and ultra-low pricing**. Nevertheless, they face major challenges in **brand attachment**. Their products are largely mass-produced and lack alignment with the unique spirit of individual schools, leading students to feel disconnected from the uniforms they wear.

Meanwhile, **Local Brands and Merchandise players** possess superior design capabilities and premium fabric quality (e.g., 100% cotton, French terry). They excel at capturing youth fashion trends but struggle with **high price points** and **scalability issues**, as their production processes are often semi-handcrafted and order volumes remain limited.

5.4. Market Gap Analysis – Opportunities for the Project

Based on observations of existing competitors, the project identifies three major unmet gaps in the student uniform market:

First, there is a clear **disconnect between uniformity and everyday usability**. Most traditional suppliers focus solely on "visual identity" while neglecting "user experience." This leaves a significant opportunity for **lifestyle-oriented products** (e.g., oversized hoodies, varsity jackets, local-brand-style T-shirts, hoodies, tote bags, socks, caps) featuring school logos but designed with contemporary aesthetics, enabling students to confidently wear them for part-time work, leisure activities, or extracurricular events.

Second, there is a **lack of structured customization services**. While Gen Z demonstrates a strong desire for self-expression, large-scale manufacturers often reject small customized orders (e.g., personal names or icons) due to cost constraints. This represents a critical touchpoint for the project to offer **controlled customization options within a standardized brand identity framework**, allowing students to feel that their uniform genuinely belongs to them.

Third, there is a notable **absence of a cohesive merchandise ecosystem**. Currently, students struggle to find high-quality, well-designed accessory collections (e.g., socks, tote bags, keychains, mouse pads) that are consistently branded and readily available on campus. Developing an **"open ecosystem"** that extends beyond apparel to everyday student items presents a highly promising niche market.

5.5. Competitive Intensity

The competitive intensity of the uniform industry is assessed as **Medium to High**. However, competition is shifting from a **price-driven race** to a **brand value-driven race**.

Structurally, the market is no longer dominated solely by local garment workshops; it is increasingly witnessing the entry of fast fashion brands and local fashion labels. Nevertheless, the biggest barrier for these players is **legitimacy and authorization** to use school logos and imagery. External brands face significant challenges in gaining student trust without institutional endorsement from the schools themselves.

In terms of market entry potential, the project holds a **unique competitive advantage** through its **"Open Ecosystem" model**. Instead of competing directly with traditional manufacturers on price, the project differentiates itself through **design experience and personalization rights**. At this stage, market entry barriers are no longer capital or machinery, but rather the ability to deeply understand **Gen Z psychology** and successfully negotiate strategic partnerships with educational institutions. If legal issues related to brand imagery are resolved, the project will establish a strong **economic moat** that is difficult for purely manufacturing-focused competitors to replicate.

6. POSITIONING

6. 1. Analysis of Competitors' Positioning Criteria

Currently, competitors in the market are positioned along the following key dimensions:

- Traditional Enterprises (e.g., Phương Thảo, Hải Anh): **Positioned in the** Mass-market & Functional **segment. Their core value proposition focuses on** low price, high durability, and compliance with school regulations**. In consumers' minds, these products are perceived as "items that must be purchased" rather than "items students want to wear."**
- Local Brands / Merchandise (e.g., Jadiny, THSM): **Positioned in the** Mid-to-Premium & Fashion-oriented **segment. These brands emphasize fabric quality and silhouette design. The emotional value they deliver is** school pride**, yet their products are often priced relatively high and offered in limited quantities.**
- Online Retailers (Shopee/TikTok shops): **Positioned in the** Low-price & Convenience-driven **segment. They appeal to consumers' desire for fast and effortless shopping; however, the emotional value and connection to school identity are virtually nonexistent.**

6.2. Positioning Gap – Opportunity for the Project

Based on the positioning map, a clear **"white space"** remains underexplored: a uniform segment that simultaneously embodies **school symbolism**, **high aesthetic appeal with personalization**, and **affordable pricing**.

Most major players are overly focused on satisfying **institutional stakeholders (B2B – schools)** while neglecting the emotions and experiences of the **end users (B2C – students)**. This gap presents a strong opportunity for the brand to position itself as a **"Campus Lifestyle Hub"**, where uniforms are no longer a constraint on individuality but a medium for **self-expression**.

6.3. Brand Positioning Strategy (Project)

The project defines its positioning through three core value pillars:

- **Price: Affordable Premium.** Pricing is higher than traditional uniforms but lower than designer-driven local brands, making it accessible to students' budgets.
- **Style: Campus Streetwear.** Transforming items such as hoodies, sweaters, and tote bags into **must-have essentials** for students' everyday wardrobes.
- **Emotional Value: A distinctive sense of belonging.** Students wear school-branded apparel while still feeling "cool" and unique through **personalization elements** (e.g., name, major, personal icons) integrated within a professional design framework.

7. COMPETITORS ANALYSIS

7.1. Objectives of the Analysis

The objective of this report is to identify and analyze the key competitor groups within the school apparel and student fashion market, with the aim of clarifying:

- How existing competitors currently address students' needs
- The structural strengths and weaknesses of each competitor group
- The market gaps that THE ALMA can strategically exploit

The analysis is conducted from a **value-delivery perspective**, focusing on the benefits provided to students rather than solely on physical products.

7.2 Overview of Key Competitor Groups

The current market can be broadly divided into three major competitor categories:

- Traditional uniform suppliers – capturing mandatory student spending
- Local streetwear and fast fashion brands – capturing discretionary and lifestyle-driven spending
- Custom merchandising and print-on-demand services – serving short-term, small-group needs

These three groups do not compete directly in all aspects; instead, each occupies a distinct share of students' wardrobes and overall apparel budgets.

7.3 Detailed Competitor Analysis

7.3.1. Traditional Uniform Suppliers

7.3.1.1. Nature of the Business Model

This group primarily operates under an exclusive **B2B model**, forming direct contracts with university administrations or student affairs offices to supply official uniforms. As a result, they maintain near-monopoly control over on-campus distribution and capture the majority of students' mandatory apparel spending.

7.3.1.2. Core Services

- Mass Production and Standardization: Focus on large-scale manufacturing with simple designs and limited variations.

- Institutional Contracting: Products are officially endorsed by the university, ensuring full regulatory compliance.
- On-Campus Distribution: Sales are conducted through student affairs offices or campus retail outlets.

7.3.1.3. Competitive Advantages

- Full Regulatory Compliance: All products strictly adhere to institutional dress codes and image guidelines.
- Cost Efficiency: Low unit costs achieved through bulk production and minimal design complexity.
- High Durability: Materials are selected for frequent washing and long-term use.

7.3.1.4. Structural Limitations

- Rigid and Outdated Design: Generic unisex silhouettes that lack aesthetic appeal and fail to accommodate diverse body types.
- Poor Wearing Experience: Fabrics are often stiff, heavy, and poorly ventilated, resulting in discomfort.
- "Forced-Wear" Psychology: Students purchase and wear uniforms out of obligation rather than pride, leading to minimal emotional attachment or brand loyalty.

7.3.1.5. Overall Assessment

Traditional uniform suppliers dominate in terms of institutional legitimacy but fail to deliver emotional value or personal identity. They are structurally strong in compliance and scale, yet weak in user experience and brand culture.

7.3.2. Local Streetwear and Fast Fashion Brands

7.3.2. Nature of the Business Model

This group operates entirely within the **open B2C market**, targeting individual consumption and lifestyle-oriented fashion choices. While unrelated to educational institutions, these brands capture a significant share of students' daily fashion spending.

7.3.2.1. Core Services

- Trend-Driven Collections: Rapid release cycles aligned with current youth fashion trends (e.g., oversized, boxy, street-style).
- Lifestyle Branding: Selling a "cool" identity and social image rather than just apparel.
- Omnichannel Retailing: Strong presence across social media platforms (TikTok, Instagram), e-commerce marketplaces, and pop-up stores.

7.3.2.2. Competitive Advantages

- High Fashion Appeal: Designs closely aligned with Gen Z aesthetics, driving strong desire and adoption.
- Strong Self-Expression Value: Products enable students to communicate personal style, taste, and social positioning.
- Superior Comfort and Materials: Frequent use of premium cotton, waffle fabrics, and technical textiles suitable for daily wear.

7.3.2.3. Structural Limitations

- Lack of Institutional Identity: These brands do not contribute to school spirit or academic community belonging.
- Higher Price Points: Often unsuitable for collective purchases by classes or faculties.
- Regulatory Conflict: Many designs are restricted or prohibited in formal academic environments.

7.2.5. Overall Assessment

Streetwear and fast fashion brands excel in aesthetics and individuality but remain disconnected from academic identity and campus community. They compete for students' wardrobe space but cannot replace school apparel.

7.3. Custom Merchandising Services

(Class shirts, club apparel, and print-on-demand services)

7.3.1. Nature of the Business Model

This group operates under a **made-to-order production model**, primarily serving short-term needs of small groups such as classes, student clubs, and event organizers.

7.3.2. Core Services

- Print-on-Demand Production
- Flexible Design Options: Customers can submit custom artwork or select from available templates.
- Small-Batch Manufacturing: Catering to low minimum order quantities (MOQs).

7.3.3. Competitive Advantages

- Maximum Personalization: Each group can fully express its unique identity.
- Enhanced Internal Cohesion: Effective for team-building and event-based bonding.
- Creative Freedom: Minimal restrictions on colors, graphics, or slogans.

7.4. Structural Limitations

- **Fragmented Institutional Branding:** Inconsistent visual identities across groups dilute the university's official image.
- **Inconsistent Quality:** Fabric and print quality vary significantly depending on vendors and production runs.
- **Amateur Aesthetics:** Designs often lack professional refinement and fashion credibility.

7.5. Overall Assessment

Custom merchandising services effectively address short-term and group-specific needs but fail to build consistent brand equity, stable quality standards, or long-term value.

Item	Group 1 – Traditional Uniform Suppliers	Group 2 – Streetwear / Fast Fashion	Group 3 – Custom Merchandising Services
Product	Regulation-compliant uniforms; standardized designs	Trend-driven apparel; lifestyle fashion items	Print-on-demand class, club, and event merchandise
Price	Low (mandatory, bulk-based pricing)	Medium–high	Low–medium (depends on quantity & vendor)
Place	On-campus stores; student affairs offices	Online platforms; social media; pop-up stores	Local print shops; online customization websites
Promotion	Institutional endorsement; administrative distribution	Social media marketing; influencers; brand image	Word-of-mouth; student networks; informal channels
Advantages	Full compliance; cost efficiency; durability	High fashion appeal; strong self-expression; high comfort	High personalization; group bonding; creative freedom

Disadvantages	Rigid aesthetics; poor comfort; forced-wear mindset	No institutional identity; high price; regulation conflicts	Inconsistent quality; amateur design; fragmented branding

8. SWOT

8.1. Overview

To evaluate the feasibility and strategic direction of the Open Uniform Ecosystem project, a SWOT analysis was conducted to examine both internal and external factors affecting its implementation. The analysis focuses on how the project's internal capabilities interact with market demand, institutional constraints, and student behavior, thereby informing long-term strategic decisions.

8.2. Strengths

The primary strength of the Open Uniform Ecosystem lies in its distinctive value proposition, which departs from the traditional uniform supply model and introduces a platform-based approach to campus apparel. By enabling controlled customization within a predefined design framework, the project successfully reconciles the university's need for brand consistency with students' demand for self-expression. This approach transforms uniforms from mandatory, regulation-driven garments into lifestyle-oriented products that students voluntarily choose to wear. Additionally, the project is strategically positioned as a complementary offering rather than a substitute for official uniforms used in formal academic contexts. By expanding beyond core apparel into accessories and casual wear, the ecosystem integrates naturally into students' everyday campus activities. The incorporation of a web-based, drag-and-drop customization platform further enhances accessibility and engagement while maintaining institutional brand safety.

8.3. Weaknesses

Despite its innovative approach, the project faces several internal challenges. The customization-driven production model introduces operational complexity that exceeds that of conventional mass production, particularly in logistics coordination, order tracking, and fulfillment processes. As order volumes increase, the risk of inefficiencies and delays becomes more pronounced without robust operational infrastructure. Furthermore, quality control presents a significant concern, as inconsistencies between digital designs and physical outputs—such as color deviations or print inaccuracies—can undermine user trust and perceived product quality. Another key weakness lies in maintaining the appropriate balance within the design framework; excessive restrictions may suppress creativity and reduce student participation, while insufficient control may compromise institutional branding standards.

8.4. Opportunities

The external environment presents substantial opportunities for the Open Uniform Ecosystem. A notable market gap exists in casual campus fashion, as students typically wear official uniforms only when mandated, leaving daily campus attire largely unaddressed by institution-linked apparel. The project capitalizes on this gap by offering culturally legitimate yet aesthetically appealing products suitable for everyday use. Moreover, the initiative aligns strongly with Generation Z's emphasis on self-expression, identity signaling, and co-creation. By shifting uniform-wearing from a compulsory act to a voluntary expression of pride, the project can foster deeper emotional engagement. The scalability of the design framework and supporting technology also presents opportunities for expansion, allowing the model to be replicated across multiple universities or youth-oriented organizations.

8.5. Threats

Despite its potential, the project faces several external threats that may impact its sustainability. Strict university brand guidelines represent the most significant risk, as any misuse or misrepresentation of institutional symbols could result in rejected designs or terminated partnerships. Additionally, traditional uniform suppliers pose competitive pressure due to their established relationships, economies of scale, and ability to offer immediate product availability. In contrast, the project's personalization-based model inherently involves longer production lead times, which may deter users seeking instant fulfillment. This sensitivity to lead time is particularly critical for customers with urgent requirements, potentially limiting adoption in certain scenarios.

9. REFERENCES

Statista. (n.d.-a). Vietnam fashion market outlook. Statista. https://www.statista.com/outlook/emo/fashion/vietnam

Ken Research. (2025). *Vietnam print on demand market: Size, share, growth drivers, trends, opportunities & forecast 2025–2030*. Ken Research. https://www.kenresearch.com/vietnam-print-on-demand-market

YouNet Media. (2025). *Vietnam e-commerce intelligence 2025 report: From consumer behavior to breakthrough growth on e-commerce*. YouNet Media. https://www.younetgroup.com/younet-vietnam-e-commerce-intelligence-2025-report

MBS Research. (2025). *Vietnam Retail & Consumer Dynamics 2025*. MBS Research. https://www.mbs.com.vn/files/uploads/2025/07/VN-Dynamics-2025_Retail_ENG.pdf

YMER Digital. (2024). *Vietnam Gen Z consumer insight report*. YMER Digital. https://ymerdigital.com/uploads/YMER2403B2.pdf

International Journal of Social Science and Economic Research. (2025). *Gen Z consumer data – Vietnam*. https://ijsser.org/2025files/ijsser_10__86.pdf

Ken Research. (2025, October). *Vietnam print on demand market: Size, share, growth drivers, trends, opportunities & forecast 2025–2030* (Author: Geetanshi). Ken Research. https://www.kenresearch.com/vietnam-print-on-demand-market

BurgerPrints. (2024). *Dự báo tiềm năng và xu hướng thị trường Print-on-Demand* [PDF]. BurgerPrints. https://burgerprints.com/wp-content/uploads/Ebook-POD-Vie-version.pdf

Nguyệt Hà & Thùy Dương. (2022, 16 tháng 3). *Thời trang Gen Z: Khi cá tính thể hiện trong từng bộ quần áo. Dân Trí*. https://dantri.com.vn/nhip-song-tre/thoi-trang-gen-z-khi-ca-tinh-the-hien-trong-tung-bo-quan-ao-20220316110537553.htm

Giao dục TP. Hồ Chí Minh. (2025, 19 tháng 12). Đồng phục Hải Anh – 11 năm đưa đồng phục thương hiệu Việt vươn tầm. Giao dục.edu.vn. https://giaoduc.edu.vn/dong-phuc-hai-anh-11-nam-dua-dong-phuc-thuong-hieu-viet-vuon-tam/

Metric.vn. (2025). Báo cáo thị trường quần đồng phục học sinh – Nghiên cứu thị trường TMĐT. Metric.vn. https://metric.vn/ereport/quan-dong-phuc-hoc-sinh

Tạp chí Giáo dục TP.HCM. (2025, 19 tháng 12). Đồng phục Hải Anh – 11 năm đưa đồng phục thương hiệu Việt vươn tầm. Giao dục.edu.vn. https://giaoduc.edu.vn/dong-phuc-hai-anh-11-nam-dua-dong-phuc-thuong-hieu-viet-vuon-tam/